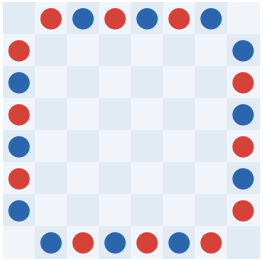
Lipfty 19 — How to play

Experimental rules, v19.0.4. Lipfty is a two-player, shared-colour strategy game. Neither player owns an ordinary playing colour. The opponent normally selects which reserve colour you must play.

1. Board and preparation

The inner 6 × 6 board starts completely empty. The surrounding outside edges hold 24 ordinary reserves: 12 of each colour. Four square-shaped special pieces, two Red and two Blue, are initially taken from the four outside corners. Each player holds one Red and one Blue special, leaving all four outside corners empty.



Empty inner 6 × 6

24 ordinary reserves

Four corner squares empty

Both players HOLD:

Red = Jump

Blue = Move

2. What the specials mean

Blue special = Move requirement. Return your Blue special automatically after your first successful Move and its compulsory placements.

Red special = Jump requirement. Return your Red special automatically after your first successful Jump and its compulsory placements.

You may do the Move and Jump in either order, whenever legal. You do not have to use the first opportunity. Further Moves and Jumps are permitted. Special colours indicate actions and do not restrict which ordinary colour can be moved or jumped. Under customised screen colours, the first/second game colour may appear in place of default Red/Blue.

3. Opening colour and Accept / Take

A starting chooser selects an ordinary reserve colour for the opponent, the first placer. The first placer places that piece anywhere on the empty inner 6 × 6. Then the chooser selects Accept (the chooser takes the next turn) or Take position (the original placer continues). The first piece never moves because of this decision. Both players keep their two held specials.

4. Ordinary turns

The opponent chooses a remaining ordinary reserve piece/colour. The active player may Place it on an empty square, Move an eligible unpinned existing board piece of that colour one adjacent square (including diagonally), or Jump that piece over an adjacent unpinned opposite-colour piece to an empty landing square two squares away. The moved/jumped piece has temporary protection from being moved again on the next turn as in Lipfty 18.

5. Compulsory consequences of a Move

If the Move does not end the game, the opponent chooses and places another ordinary reserve piece. Then the mover places the exact originally handed piece. A Move is legal only if that additional ordinary reserve piece is available. An earned Blue special returns automatically to the first vacant outside corner after the compulsory placements. A later Move does not return another special. Before both specials return, a Move that would complete four in a line or tight square is illegal.



Two compulsory placements; opponent first, actor second

6. Compulsory consequences of a Jump

If the Jump does not end the game, the jumped piece is temporarily removed. The opponent chooses which exact piece to place first — the jumped piece or the originally handed piece — and places it on an empty square. The jumper then places the other exact piece. An earned Red special automatically returns to an empty outside corner after these placements. A later Jump does not return another special. A legal winning placement by an already-qualified player cancels remaining compulsory placements.



Two compulsory placements; opponent first, actor second

7. How to win: illegal patterns until both specials return

Before BOTH your Red Jump and Blue Move specials have returned to the outside corners, completing a four-piece winning pattern is ILLEGAL, not a non-winning pattern. This applies to Place, Move, Jump, and each compulsory placement, irrespective of which ordinary colour forms it. In Easy, a winning pattern is four in a horizontal, vertical or diagonal line. Standard also allows a tight 2 × 2 square. Large/spaced squares never count. Three in a row is legal and creates tactical threats.

A Move or Jump that earns your second special cannot itself create four: the special returns only after its compulsory placements. A Jump is evaluated on its finished position after removal of the jumped piece, not the intermediate landing position. Illegal actions are rejected without consuming the reserve piece or changing the board.

Once BOTH of your specials have physically returned, your legal four-piece line or tight square wins normally, even if your opponent has not qualified. A legal winning compulsory placement ends the game immediately.



Line: Easy / Standard



Tight 2×2: Standard

7A. If no legal action remains

When a compulsory placement is required but every remaining empty square is forbidden, the player who must place the piece loses immediately. Their opponent wins by forfeit, even if the opponent has not completed Move and Jump.

On an ordinary turn, there is no forfeit if a legal Move or Jump is still available. The same immediate-loss rule applies only when no legal Place, Move or Jump remains. This can occur even when the board has many empty squares. A player cannot pass a compulsory obligation.

8. Ordinary-reserve deadline

Unlike v18, a Move or Jump can remain legal after the first ordinary reserve colour runs out. Both qualifications must be completed by the time all 24 ordinary reserve pieces have been placed (after resolving any compulsory placements). Then:

1. If exactly one player has completed both Move and Jump, that player wins by the other player's qualification failure. 2. If neither player has completed both, neither wins. The game ends without a winner. 3. If both players qualify, the game continues into Final Four.

No player receives an automatic win merely because they had the first or second turn. The rule against unqualified four-piece patterns and the immediate-loss rule for having no legal action remain in force. A Move still requires an additional unreserved ordinary piece.

9. Final Four

Once the ordinary reserves are exhausted, if both players have qualified, all four special pieces have automatically returned to the outside corners. Players now choose and place a corner piece on their own turn. Once placed on the inner board, it is permanently pinned. No Move or Jump occurs in Final Four. The ordinary Easy/Standard winning patterns still apply. Four corner placements without a winner result in a draw.

10. Settings and game integrity

Retain Easy and Standard, opponent-chosen shared colours, computer difficulty settings, configurable computer action delay (2 seconds by default), Undo, clocks, sound, accessibility and offline play. There is no Best of 3/5 mode or placement-only Learning mode. A clock expiry cannot award victory to an unqualified opponent under this experimental rule. v18.0.17 remains the stable rollback version.